

CSA1402 Compiler Design

1. Scenario: Parsing Table Conflict in LL(1), while designing an LL(1) parser, a student constructs a parsing table and finds multiple entries in a single cell for a non-terminal and input symbol combination. This leads to confusion. Identify the reason and explain its effect on deterministic parsing.
- * LL(1) parser uses FIRST and FOLLOW sets to build the parsing table.
 - * A conflict occurs when a table cell contains more than one production.
 - * This happens due to left recursion, common prefixes (left factoring) or ambiguous grammar.
 - * The parser cannot decide which production to apply.
 - * This makes parsing non-deterministic.
 - * Decision: Remove left recursion, apply left factoring and ensure no FIRST/FOLLOW overlap to obtain an LL(1) grammar.

2. Scenario: Incorrect Parse tree Generation A Syntax analyzer generates a parse tree for the expression $id + id - id$, but the evaluation gives incorrect results due to improper grouping of operators.

- * The Syntax analyzer builds a parse tree using grammar rules
- * Incorrect grouping changes the expression evaluation.
- * The issue is caused by missing associativity rules.
- * Multiple parse trees may be generated for the same expression.
- * Addition and Subtraction should follow left associativity.
- * Decision: Modify the grammar to enforce left associativity for correct parsing.

Scenario: Invalid Expression Handling, A syntax analyser in a compiler receives the token sequence corresponding to the expression $a + * b$ from the lexical analyser.

- * The expression $a + * b$ has valid tokens by an invalid order.
- * After '+', the grammar expects an operand, not another operator.
- * Predictive parsing reports an error when no valid production exists.
- * Shift-reduce parsing reports an error when no valid action available. Parsing stops without recovery.
- * Decision: Use panic-mode or phrase-level error recovery with meaningful error messages.

4. Ambiguity in Conditional Statements

- * The grammar is ambiguous because of the dangling else problem.
- * The parser cannot decide which if matches the else.

- * This creates parsing conflicts and multiple parse trees.
- * Deterministic parsing becomes difficult.
- * Rewrite the grammar using matched & unmatched statements.
- * Decision: Associate else with the nearest unmatched if.

5. Operator Precedence Conflict

- * The grammar is ambiguous because precedence is not defined.
- * The expression $id + id * id$ can produce different parse trees.
- * Multiplication should follow ~~left~~ higher precedence than addition.
- * Operators should follow left associativity.
- * Ambiguity leads to incorrect evaluation.
- * Decision: Rewrite the grammar using separate non-terminals (E, T, F) or use precedence declarations in the parser.